EXECUTIVE BRIEFING · OPERATOR LAYER

Module 3 Insider Playbook

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MODULE 3 INSIDER PLAYBOOK — THE PITCH WEAPON: What the Promotion Industry Knows About Attention

Executive briefing. The craft layer under the lessons. Read after 3.1–3.4.

THE FOUR-SECOND STACK (THE ACTUAL ATTENTION ECONOMY)

A PD's evaluation isn't a read — it's a **stack of four-second decisions**:

1. **Inbox preview (4s)** — subject line + sender + first line. If the subject is vague, dead.
2. **Body scan (4s)** — "who is this, is there a receipt, what's the ask?" If the proof isn't in the first 20 words, dead.
3. **Asset sample (4s)** — one click: is the audio playable in 60 seconds? If it needs a player, a login, or a download, dead.
4. **Ask decision (4s)** — is the request yes-able in one sentence? If the ask is a list, dead.

Design every payload to win all four stacks before the PD has to think. That's what the 90-word pitch, the one-page EPK, and the 3-file audio package are for. The weapon isn't the pitch — it's the **zero-thought path to a yes.**

THE DOMAIN & DELIVERY PROTOCOL (THE HIDDEN CREDIBILITY SIGNAL)

Decision-makers evaluate the sender, not just the message:

- **Send from a real domain**, not gmail.com. `pitch@yourname.com` reads operator; `yourname99@gmail.com` reads bedroom. Domain + professional signature is the cheapest status signal in the game.
- **Never send a zip, a folder, or a Dropbox link that requires a click-through.** One link per payload. One attachment per payload (the 90-sec file). Everything else lives on the EPK page.
- **File naming is branding:** `ARTIST-SONG-90SEC`, `ARTIST-SONG-CLEAN-WAV`, `ARTIST-EPK`. A PD forwarding your file forwards your professionalism.
- **Test the mobile path** — 80% of first opens happen on a phone. Open your own email on your phone and time it: how many seconds until the song is playing? If it's over 60, rework the payload.

THE PROOF-SHAPING TRICK (HOW LABELS FRAME RECEIPTS)

A receipt is a fact. **Framing is the weapon.** Same number, different command:

- Raw: "2,100 streams this month."
- Framed: "2,100 streams this month — [NUMBER] of them in [your station's metro], up [NUMBER]% since the radio adds."
- Super-framed: "[Sister station] added it last week and [metro] streams jumped [NUMBER]% — this is the track your audience is already showing up for."

Always include: the market, the trend, and the third-party source. A PD doesn't buy your number — they buy the direction of your number in their market.

THE TWO-EMAIL SYSTEM (THE INDUSTRY'S ACTUAL CADENCE)

Promo houses don't send one email per station. They run **two waves per cycle**:

- **Wave A — the service email:** subject + proof + ask (your 90-word pitch). Purpose: get the listen.
- **Wave B — the value email (48h later):** "here's the 90-sec promo built for your board" or "here's the listener-proof from [metro]." Purpose: get the add.

Wave B is where most adds actually land — and 90% of independents never send it because they think one email equals one campaign. The two-email system is the single highest-ROI change in this module.

THE SUBJECT-LINE MATH (BORROWED FROM DIRECT-RESPONSE)

- 4–7 words wins. Long subjects get truncated on mobile — and truncation kills the engine.
- **Personal names in subjects** lift opens on cold lists. **Numbers in subjects** lift opens on proof-led lists. **Format-show references** lift opens on specialty lists. Match the engine to the station type, or the open dies.
- **Never reuse a subject that failed twice.** Two failures = the angle is wrong for that list; change engines, not words.
- **Track everything in T3.1.** Your personal data of your market beats every general rule ever written.

THE AUDIO WEAPON: WHAT LABELS ACTUALLY SERVICE

The industry's service standard isn't "a song" — it's a **radio package**:

1. **The 90-second promo** (hook + voice + CTA) — the pitch in audio form.
2. **The radio edit** (clean, 3:00–3:45, hook < 12s) — the inventory.
3. **The 30-second payload** (for IDs, beds, and the promo team) — the derivative that gets forwarded.

Produce all three before the first send. The hour you spend in the studio saves 20 hours of campaign repair — because a PD who has to ask "do you have a clean edit?" is a PD who hasn't added you yet.

THE ONE SECRET MOST ARTISTS NEVER LEARN

The reply you want is not "we'll play it." The reply you want is a question. "Send the WAV," "what's the clean edit?" — that's the PD engaging with the logistics of saying yes, which means the decision is already 80% made. When you get a question, treat it as a **yes in progress**: answer within 4 hours with a phone number and a 12-minute call offer. This is the highest-leverage moment in the entire campaign and almost nobody recognizes it.

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